Q. IS BNCAP A STEP IN THE RIGHT DIRECTION AND HOW WILL IT HELP MAKE SAFER CARS FOR INDIA?



● TARUN GARG

BNCAP (Bharat New Car Assessment Program) is indeed a positive step forward for India's automotive safety standards. Through rigorous testing and assessment criteria, BNCAP aims to raise awareness about vehicle safety and encourage the adoption of advanced safety technologies, which can significantly reduce the risk of accidents and injuries on Indian roads.

● NALINIKANTH GOLLAGUNTA

Safety has always been our top priority, which is evident in our products consistently receiving 5-star and 4-star Global NCAP (GNCAP) ratings. The launch of Bharat NCAP is a commendable initiative by MoRTH, and we believe it will further elevate the standards of vehicle safety in India. We will continue to keep customers at the forefront of our journey of innovation, integrating safety with advanced technology while shaping a safer automotive future for India.

● SANTOSH IYER

The implementation of BNCAP will pave the way for the Indian auto industry reaching international standards even faster. It empowers the Indian customer, enabling them to make informed decisions while buying their new car. BNCAP can be a win-win proposition, bolstering the overall automotive ecosystem comprising OEMS, independent vehicle testing and homologation authorities and also the policy makers; all of them working towards offering safer vehicles for Indian consumers.

● SANTOSH IYER

Safety is the core competency and core value of Mercedes-Benz and our vehicles are smarter and safer than ever before. We use the latest generation connected car technologies, and our cars are already equipped with Level 2 ADAS features, which Mercedes-Benz pioneered in India. Mercedes-Benz has consistently been a pioneer in automated driving. Globally, we are the only car maker with the world's first internationally valid system approval for conditionally automated driving and a SAE Level 4 driverless parking system in place. In addition to launching the safest cars for Indian roads, Mercedes-Benz is committed to creating road safety awareness and behavioural changes among road users. We have successfully conducted road safety initiative like 'Safe Roads' with our sister concern MBRDI and our upcoming projects focus on making Safe Highways. We are also rolling out awareness programmes on road safety among school students in Maharashtra during their formative years, resulting in responsible citizens and road users who are aware.

Q. SAFETY AWARENESS HAS INCREASED POST-PANDEMIC. HOW ARE DEALERSHIPS RESPONDING TO THIS?

● TARUN GARG

Modern customers view cars as an extension of their lifestyle and choose vehicles that reflect their personality. Over the years, safety has emerged as a paramount concern in this context. At Hyundai, we are committed to consistently improving the safety standards of our products. We have been a forerunner in democratising safety interventions across our line-up. As a testament towards manufacturing 'safer cars for India', the Hyundai VERNA has scored a five star rating in Adult & Child Occupant Protection by Global NCAP. Hyundai Motor India also proactively standardised safety by introducing 3-point seatbelts with seatbelt reminders for all seats and raised the safety bar by making 6 airbags standard throughout our model and variant line-up. Last but not least, the Advanced Driver Assistance System (ADAS) is now offered as an optional feature across seven of our models.

● NALINIKANTH GOLLAGUNTA

Post-pandemic, there has been a noticeable shift in consumer awareness towards vehicle safety at our dealerships. This heightened awareness is matched by Mahindra's commitment to safety, evidenced by our high GNCAP safety ratings and the incorporation of advanced safety features across our vehicle range. Our dealerships actively engage in educating customers about these features, reflecting our dedication to meeting and exceeding customer expectations.

● SANTOSH IYER

While we continue to adhere to post-pandemic norms, frequency of road travel has increased across the country with customers increasingly preferring the safety, comfort and convenience of private modes of transport. We have witnessed this trend at our franchise partners, with increased customer queries for larger SUVs, and on the range of our EVs and their suitability for inter-city travels. Overall safety awareness among customers has increased with more road trips and we take this opportunity to engage customers, acquainting them with the various ADAS features in our vehicles, which are essential safety features. While road travel brings comfort and convenience, we advise customers on various safety precautions to make it a more pleasurable experience.